Avelumab — metastatic Merkel-cell carcinoma

National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00535 · Draft source reconciliation; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

PRACTICAL TREATMENT GUIDE

Practical treatment planning

Agree the arrangements with your oncology team.

STEP 1

Taking or receiving treatment

Avelumab 800 mg is infused over 60 minutes. An antihistamine and paracetamol are given before the first four infusions; NCCP specifies at least 30 minutes beforehand. After that, premedication is at consultant discretion if no reaction occurred. Allow additional time for checks, preparation and observation.

STEP 2

Missed, vomited or held treatment

Contact the unit if a visit is missed or treatment is held. A new appointment and any changed premedication or infusion plan must be confirmed by the team. A severe infusion or immune reaction can change whether treatment is restarted at all.

STEP 3

Appointments and supply

Before each visit, check four things: the blood-test booking, how you will get there, your medicine supply and any help you need. Ask who will review the results and tell you whether the next dose can go ahead.

STEP 4

Paper copies and contacts

Keep the handbook, short guide and treatment card in one place. Ask your team to fill in the real daytime and emergency numbers and print a replacement when the plan changes. A phone is optional.

Sources: NCCP 00535 v7: current regimen source. Draft source reconciliation; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending.